

Header Tags

Header tags enable us to easily create nice bold text to spruce up the appearance of our web pages. Header tags use the format `<hx>` where x is an integer 1,2,3,4... The smaller the number, the larger the header. The truth is you already know about this since you've probably used different levels of headers in your word processing program.

Header tags have an opening and closing tag. The general syntax is:

```
<hx> Your text here </hx>
```

Working on our previous example, we can make the phrase "Hello World!" a header by using the `<h1>` tag:

```
<h1>Hello World!</h1>
```

If our entire html looks like this:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>
<h1>Hello World!</h1><br>
My name is Joe.<br>
My friend is Sally.
</body>
</html>
```

The result we see is:

Hello World!

My name is Joe.

My friend is Sally.

When you add a header tag, the text between the header tags is not automatically centered. We have to do that manually. Let's change our html to:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>
<center><h1>Hello World!</h1></center><br>
My name is Joe.<br>
My friend is Sally.
</body>
</html>
```

Now the page appears as:

Hello World!

My name is Joe.

My friend is Sally.

We can also enhance the appearance of the page by adding *subheadings*. This is done by specifying the header level with an integer larger than 1. For example <h1>,<h2>,<h3> etc. where <h1> is the highest header level, so will have the largest text.

Let's add a header and put a subject heading as follows:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>  
<html>  
<body>  
<center><h1>Hello World!</h1></center><br>  
<h2>Friends</h2>  
My name is Joe.<br>  
My friend is Sally.  
</body>  
</html>
```

Now the web page looks like this:

Hello World!

Friends

My name is Joe.

My friend is Sally.

Notice that some spacing is automatically placed in between the header and the text that follows. Basically this is working like you were just typing away in a word processor, except we are putting in the formatting commands behind the scenes.

In the next chapter, we'll see how to format text colors.